Ideation Phase
Empathize & Discover

Date	31 January 2025
Team ID	
Project Name	Streamlining IT Procurement: Automating Standard Laptop Orders with Flow Designer
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviors and attitudes. It helps a team step into the user's shoes, understand what they say, think, do and feel, and spot the pains and gains that should shape the solution.
For this project, empathy maps were built for the two people most affected by the current laptop ordering process: the employee who needs a device and the IT procurement coordinator who fulfils it.

Step-1: Empathy Map for the Requesting Employee

Persona: Riya, new employee
Needs a standard laptop ready before her first day

Says

- "When will my laptop arrive?"
- "Who do I ask for an update?"
- "I cannot start work without a device."

Thinks

- "Why does a standard laptop need so many approvals?"
- "Is my request stuck or just slow?"
- "This should be simple."

Does

- Emails IT and her manager for status
- Fills in a request form with details IT already has
- Waits, then follows up repeatedly

Feels

- Anxious about starting without equipment
- Frustrated by the lack of visibility
- Unsure the request is moving

Pains

- No clear status after submitting
- Long waits for manual approvals
- Repeating information in the request

Gains

- One simple catalog item for a standard laptop
- Automatic approval and clear status updates
- Laptop ready on day one

Step-2: Empathy Map for the IT Procurement Coordinator

Persona: Arjun, IT procurement coordinator
Fulfils laptop orders from stock or vendors

Says

- "I keep re-entering the same details."
- "Is this request approved yet?"
- "Do we have this model in stock?"

Thinks

- "Most of these requests are identical."
- "I should not need to chase every approval."
- "One missed step delays the whole order."

Does

- Checks inventory by hand
- Chases managers for approvals
- Creates purchase orders and asset records manually

Feels

- Stretched by repetitive tasks
- Worried about errors and delays
- Frustrated by constant status questions

Pains

- Manual steps between request and delivery
- Frequent status inquiries
- Errors from re-keying data

Gains

- Flow Designer handles routine steps automatically
- Time for exceptions and vendor negotiation
- Accurate records and fewer interruptions

Key insight: both people struggle with the same thing, a process that depends on manual hand-offs and gives no clear status. Automating standard laptop orders with Flow Designer addresses both.

Screenshots

Screenshots from the ServiceNow prototype showing what the requesting employee (Riya) would see with the automated process: a single catalog item and a visible request status.

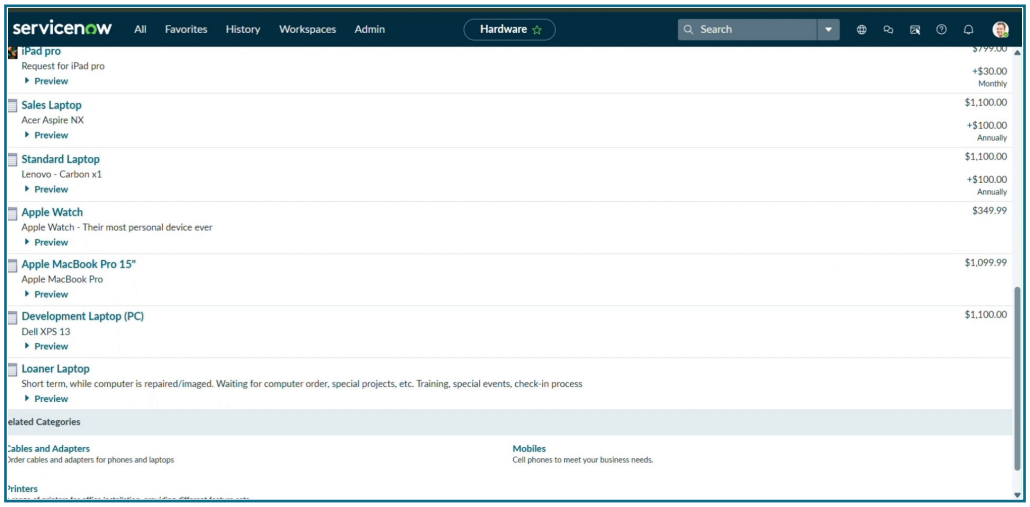


Figure 1: Standard Laptop available as one simple catalog item under Hardware

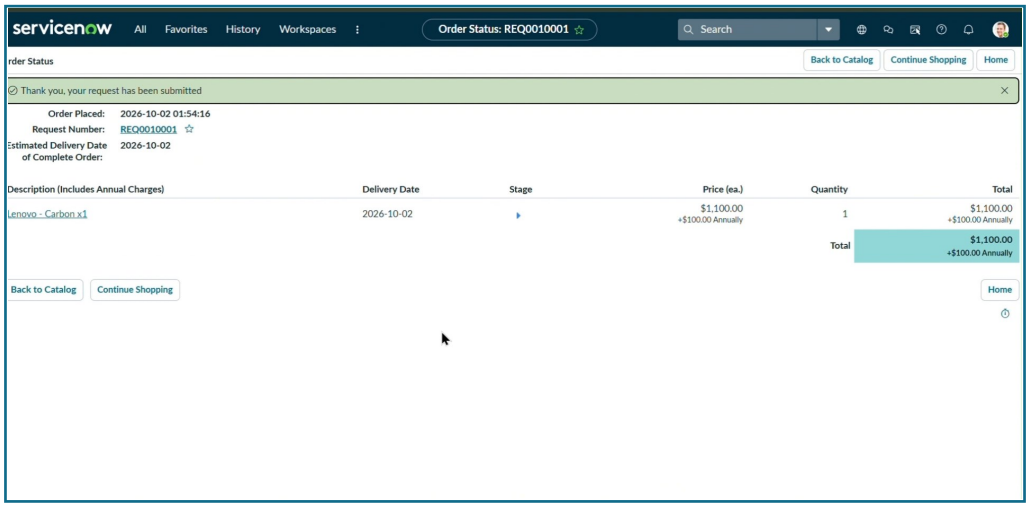


Figure 2: Order Status page after submission, showing request REQ0010001 and its status